Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles
Primary 1

20 single-page puzzles
Every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This pack belongs to

_____

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Notes

The licence is for the edition bought. The school name shown on each page is set when the pack is made.

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Teacher notes

What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages). Pages can be used in any order.

Every page checks itself

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes.
- **Logic grid.** Each number or price has a letter; the letters, read down the list, must spell a word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the stated total.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

For every page, a script tried each single wrong answer (one answer changed by 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 or 10, or any other value in the page's range) and every wrong arrangement of the logic pages. The check rejected at least 95% of them on every page.

Teacher notes: using the pages

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (P1-01, P1-12, P1-14) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). The outline is printed black and white; the colour words in the key are what the pupil follows.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **When to use.** Money, time, length, shapes and picture graphs are usually taught later in the year. Check your scheme of work before giving out P1-06 and P1-15 to P1-20.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only; the back of a copy stays blank. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on P1-17 a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

What is in this pack

Part	Pages	Photocopy for pupils?
Cover	1	No
Photocopy licence	1	No
Teacher notes	2	No
Contents	1	No
Puzzle pages P1-01 to P1-20	20	Yes
Complete pack to print	**25**	The teacher answer key is a separate file.

Contents

Page	Puzzle	Topic	Tier
P1-01	Colour the Rocket	Place value: tens and ones	1 star
P1-02	Mystery Numbers	Numbers to 100: tens digit, ones digit, more and less	2 stars
P1-03	Number Cards	Ordering numbers to 100 (smallest to greatest)	1 star
P1-04	Sticker Grid	Comparing numbers to 100 (more, fewer, greatest, smallest)	2 stars
P1-05	Missing Numbers	Number patterns: count on and count back	1 star
P1-06	Shape Riddles	2D shapes: name and describe (straight and curved sides)	2 stars
P1-07	The Queue	Ordinal numbers: 1st to 5th, before and behind	2 stars
P1-08	Make Twelve	Addition within 20	1 star
P1-09	Magic Square	Adding three 1-digit numbers	2 stars
P1-10	Take Away Code	Subtraction within 20; missing numbers	1 star
P1-11	Shape Sums	Add and subtract within 20: find the missing number	2 stars
P1-12	Colour the House	Shapes: corners and straight sides	1 star
P1-13	Equal Groups	Multiplication: equal groups	1 star
P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s	2 stars
P1-15	Coin Purses	Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)	1 star
P1-16	Shop Prices	Money: dollars, more and less	2 stars
P1-17	How Long?	Length: measure in centimetres	1 star
P1-18	Clock Time	Time: tell time to 5 minutes; 1 hour and half an hour later	2 stars
P1-19	Shape Count	2D shapes: rectangle, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle	1 star
P1-20	Fruit Graph	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer	2 stars

Pages are independent. Pick any page.

P1-01

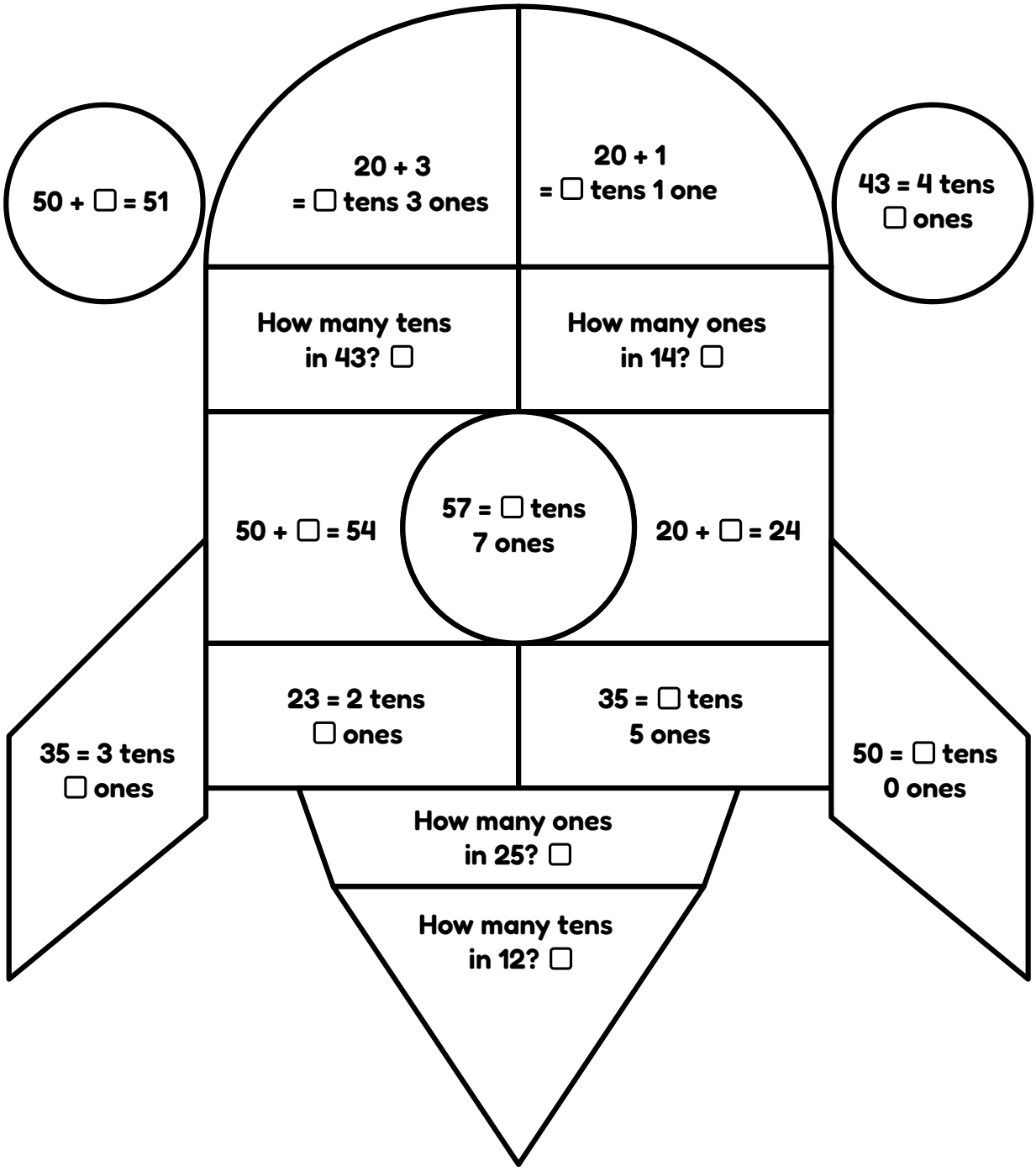
Colour the Rocket

★ Name _____

Topic: Place value: tens and ones

Find the missing number in each part.
Find it in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

1	2	3	4	5
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 2, blue 3, green 4, orange 4.
The two sides of the rocket match: parts that mirror each other have the same colour.

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P1-02

Mystery Numbers

★★ Name _____

Topic: Numbers to 100: tens digit, ones digit, more and less

Find each mystery number.
Write it in the box.
Use the code table.

1. My ones digit is 6.
   I am less than 73.
   I am more than 59. ☐

2. My ones digit is 5.
   I am less than 95.
   I am more than 82. ☐

3. My tens digit is more than 2.
   I am less than 38.
   My ones digit is 6. ☐

4. I am less than 61.
   My ones digit is 6.
   My tens digit is more than 4. ☐

5. I am more than 23.
   My ones digit is 6.
   I am less than 34. ☐

Code table

16 = F	26 = D	35 = H	36 = O	55 = X	56 = U
58 = G	66 = C	85 = L	95 = Q		

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it in the sky? ☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-03

Number Cards

★ Name _____

Topic: Ordering numbers to 100 (smallest to greatest)

Look at the six cards.
Arrange the numbers in order.
Begin with the smallest.
Write each number, then its letter below.

80	85	22	71	78	43
G	E	B	I	D	R

smallest ⟶ **greatest**

number						
letter						

Check it. Read the letters in your boxes. Do they spell a word? It crosses a river.

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P1-04

Sticker Grid

★★ Name _____

Topic: Comparing numbers to 100 (more, fewer, greatest, smallest)

Read the clues.
Cross a box if a clue says no.
Tick a box if it must be yes.
Write each number, then its letter.

The numbers of stickers are:

12 (S)	23 (U)	63 (H)	78 (O)	99 (E)

- Ali has fewer than Mei.
- Kumar has more than Mei.
- Ben has fewer than Siti.
- Ali has more than Siti.

How to use the grid

	5	9
Zed	✓	✗
Yan	✗	

Clue: Zed has 5.
Tick Zed under 5.
Cross out the rest of that line across and down.

	12	23	63	78	99
Ali					
Mei					
Siti					
Ben					
Kumar					

	number	letter
Ali		
Mei		
Siti		
Ben		
Kumar		

Check it. Read the five letters down your list. Do they spell a word? You live in it.

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P1-05

Missing Numbers

Name _____

Topic: Number patterns: count on and count back

Each row is a number pattern.
One number is missing.
Write the missing number.
Use the code table.

1	37	38	39		41	42
2	7	9	11	13		17
3	12	22	32		52	62
4	70	60	50	40		20
5	31		27	25	23	21
6	2	5	8		14	17

Code table

1 = V	11 = R	15 = L	28 = Y	29 = E	30 = W
38 = J	39 = Z	40 = F	42 = O	43 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it a garden plant?

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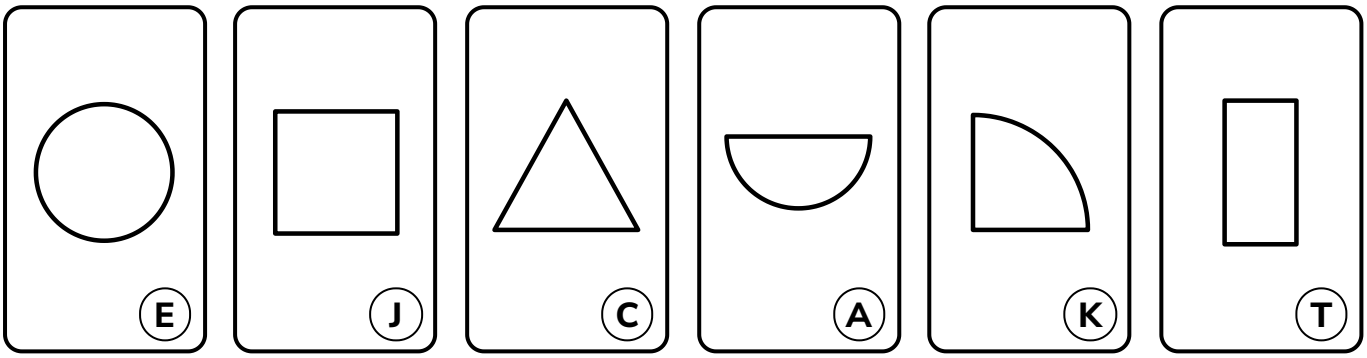
P1-06

Shape Riddles

★★ Name _____

Topic: 2D shapes: name and describe (straight and curved sides)

Each riddle is about one shape.
Find the shape it describes.
Write that shape's letter in the box.



1. I have 4 straight sides.
   All my sides are the same length. ☐
2. I have 1 curved side.
   I have 1 straight side. ☐
3. I have 3 corners.
   I have 3 straight sides. ☐
4. I have 1 curved side.
   I have 2 straight sides. ☐
5. I have 1 curved side.
   I have no straight sides. ☐
6. I have 4 straight sides.
   Two sides are long and two are short. ☐

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word? You can wear it. ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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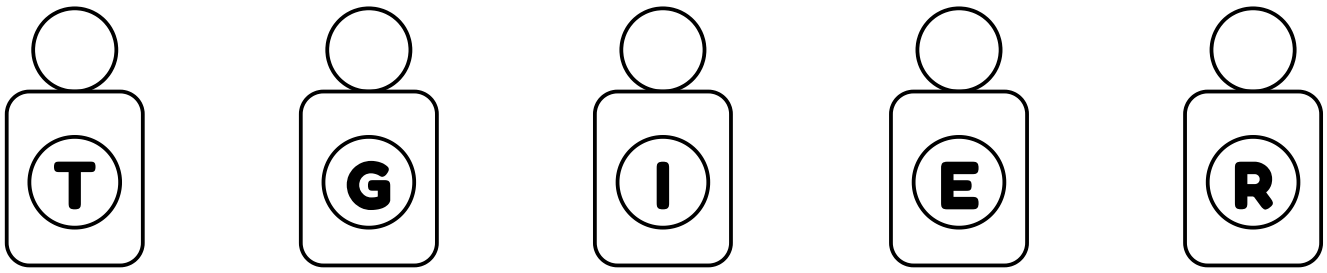
P1-07

The Queue

★★ Name _____

Topic: Ordinal numbers: 1st to 5th, before and behind

The children stand in a queue.
Read the clues.
Write each name in its place.
Then read the shirt letters.



Jenny **Ali** **Aisha** **Ravi** **Lily**

- Aisha is 2nd in the queue.
- Ali is 3rd in the queue.
- Lily is last.
- Jenny is first.

The queue. The front is 1st.

1st ☐

2nd ☐

3rd ☐

4th ☐

5th ☐

Check it. Read the shirt letters from 1st to 5th. They spell a word. Is it an animal? ☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-08

Make Twelve

★ Name _____

Topic: Addition within 20

Start at START.
Step only on sums that make 12.
Move up, down, left or right.
Draw a line to FINISH.

4 + 6	3 + 8	9 + 3	5 + 5	6 + 6
6 + 2	2 + 8	4 + 8	5 + 7	4 + 8
9 + 5	9 + 2	8 + 4	8 + 8	START 8 + 4
FINISH 6 + 6	9 + 7	5 + 7	9 + 3	5 + 8
8 + 4	5 + 7	7 + 5	6 + 7	8 + 2

Check it. Your line reaches FINISH. Count its boxes: are there 10? Does every box make 12?

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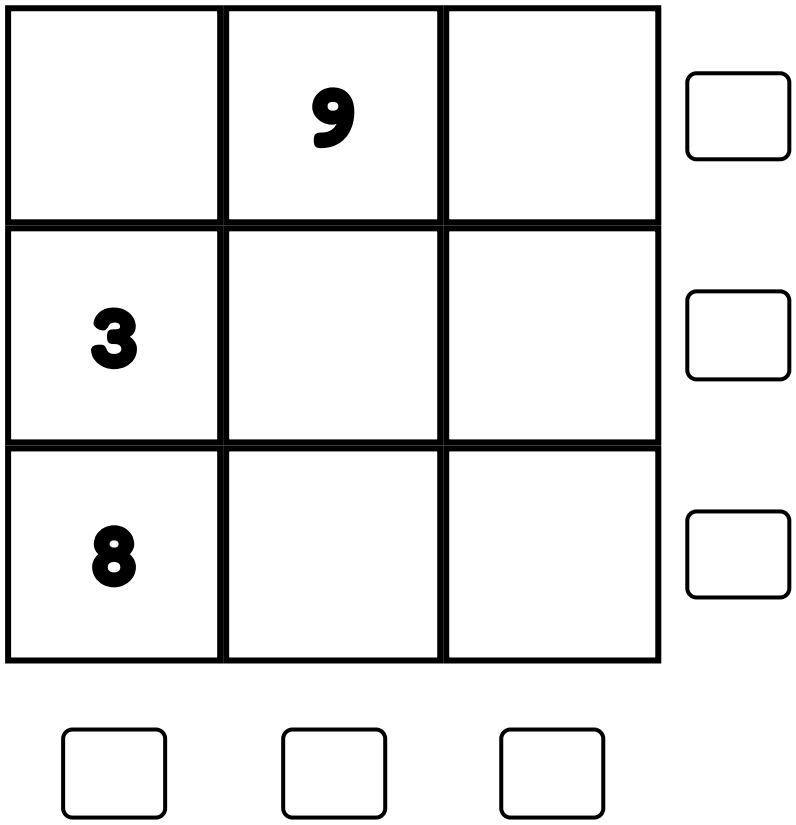
P1-09

Magic Square

★★ Name _____

Topic: Adding three 1-digit numbers

Use the numbers 1 to 9 once.
Every line across makes 15.
Every line down makes 15.
Both corner lines make 15.



Corner to corner: ☐ and ☐

Numbers to use. Cross out each one you use.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Check it. Write each line total in the small boxes. Are all eight totals 15?

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P1-10

Take Away Code

★ Name _____

Topic: Subtraction within 20; missing numbers

Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 11 – 3 = ☐

② 11 – 6 = ☐

③ 17 – 6 = ☐

④ 11 – 5 = ☐

⑤ 13 – ☐ = 9

⑥ 13 – ☐ = 10

Code table

2 = D	3 = E	4 = L	5 = A	6 = T	8 = C
10 = G	11 = S	12 = Y	13 = Q	15 = W	

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it where a king lives?

☐☐☐☐☐☐

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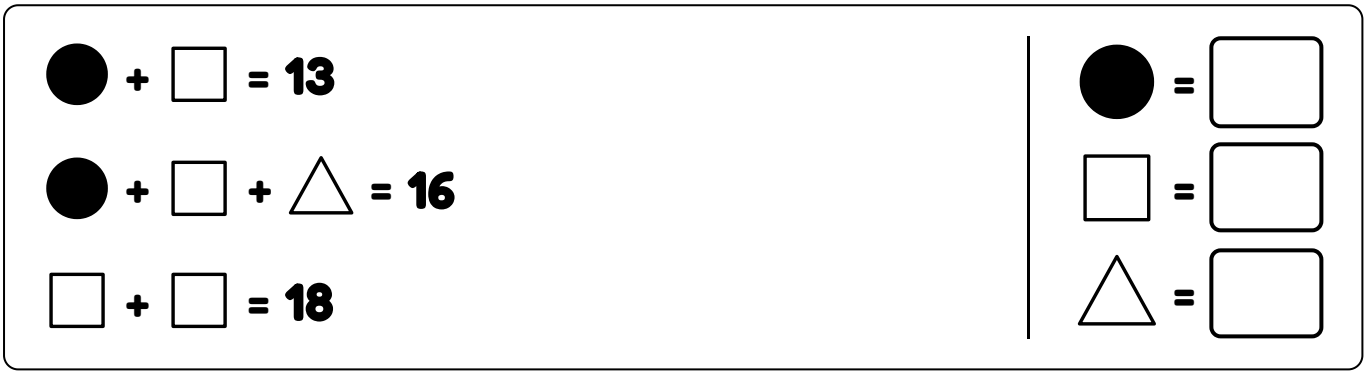
P1-11

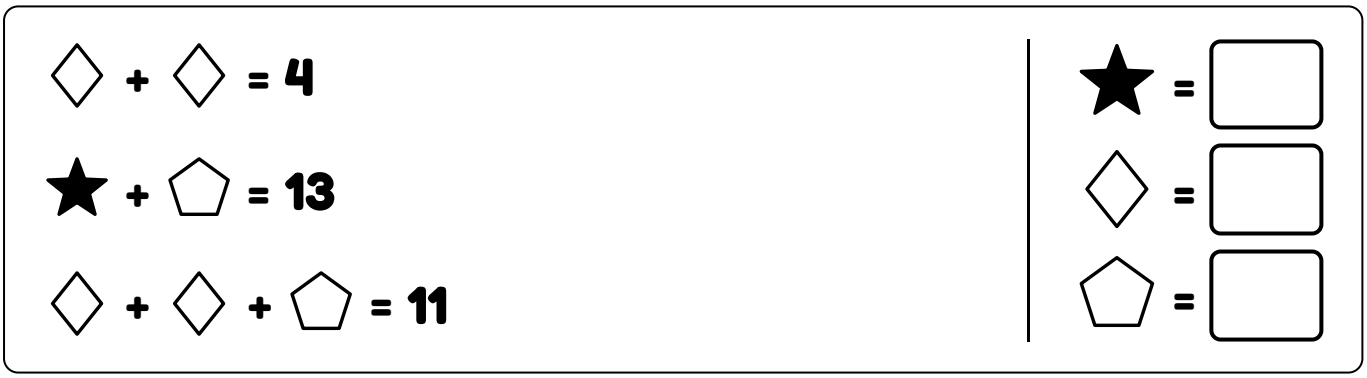
Shape Sums

★★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract within 20: find the missing number

Each shape stands for a number.
Same shape, same number.
Find the number for each shape.
Use the code table.





Code table

1 = C	2 = N	3 = R	4 = S	5 = W	6 = I
7 = G	8 = X	9 = P			

Check it. Put your numbers back in each sum. Then write the letters. Is it a season?

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P1-12

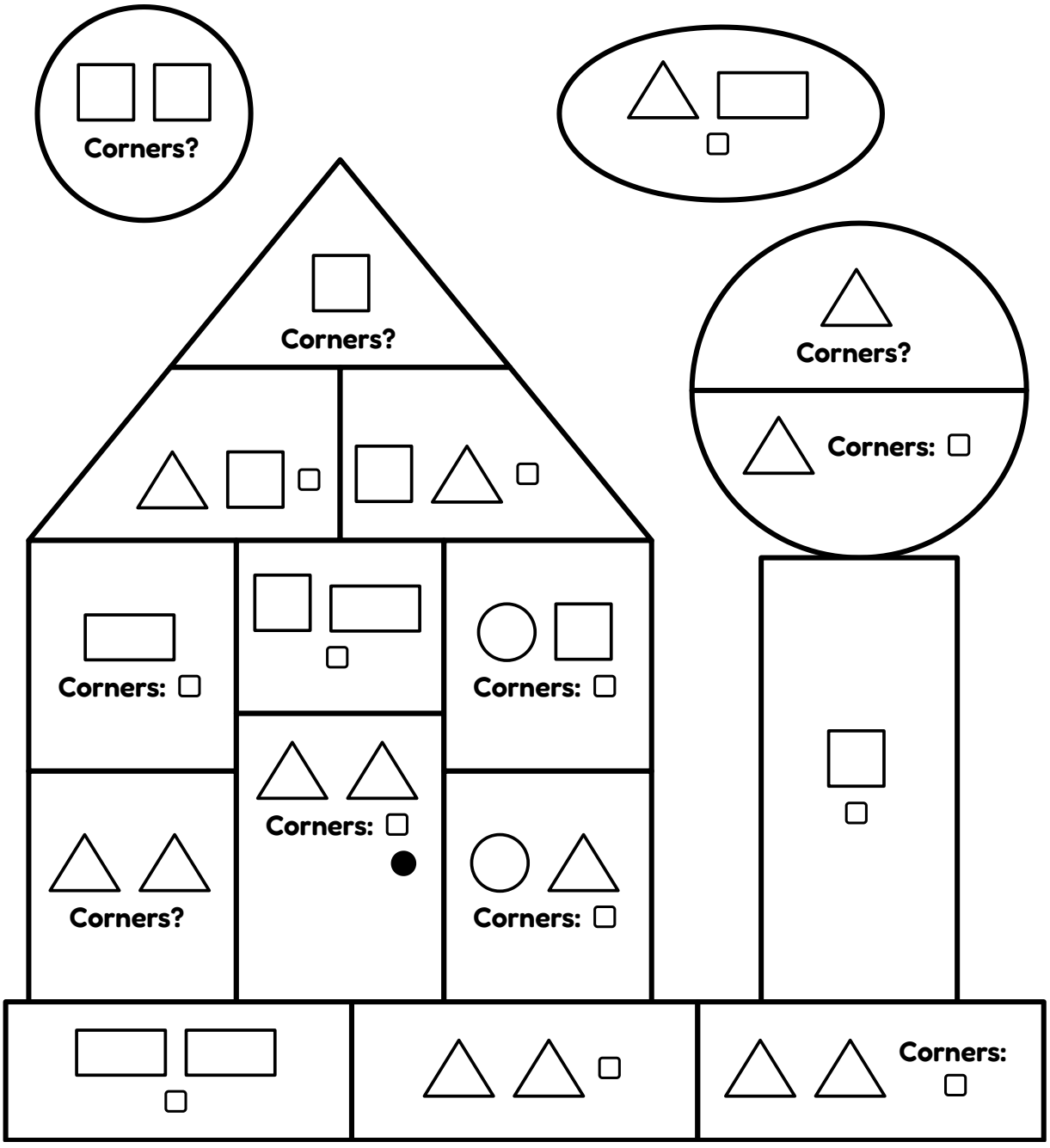
Colour the House

Name _____

Topic: Shapes: corners and straight sides

Count the corners in each part.
Find the number in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

3	4	6	7	8
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 3, red 4, blue 4, green 3, orange 3.
One colour each: the two sides of the roof; the two windows; both tree top parts.
The house has 6 wall and window parts. Exactly 2 are red.

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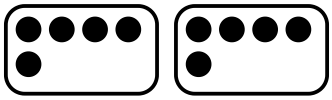
P1-13

Equal Groups

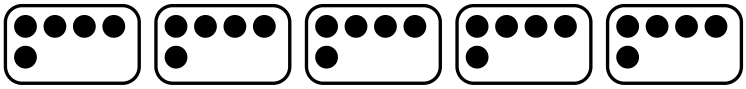
★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication: equal groups

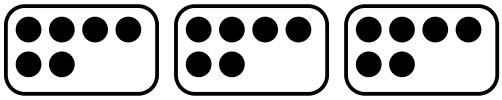
Each bag has the same number of dots.
Write the bags, the dots and the total.
Use the code table.

1 

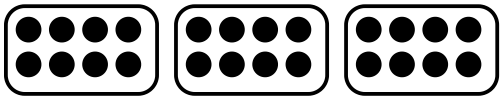
☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

2 

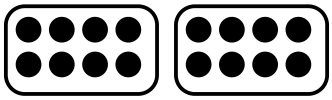
☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

3 

☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

4 

☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

5 

☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

6 

☐ bags × ☐ dots = ☐ total

Code table

6 = X	10 = P	12 = G	15 = H	16 = E	17 = Y
18 = A	20 = T	21 = Q	24 = N	25 = L	

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it in space? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-14

Colour the Ice Cream

★★ Name _____

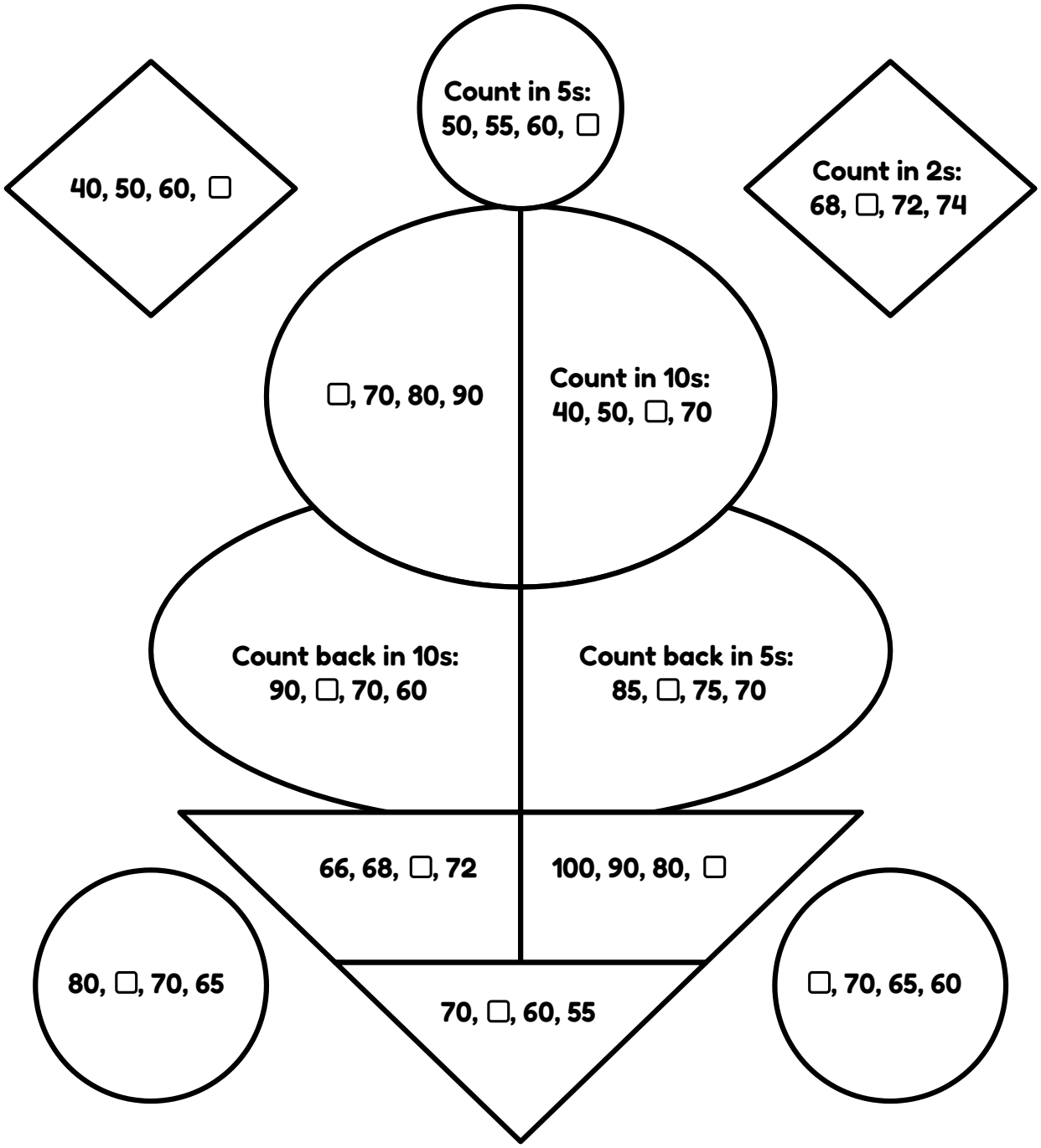
Topic: Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s

Find the missing number in each pattern.

Find it in the key.

Colour the part with that colour.

60	65	70	75	80
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.

Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 2, blue 4, green 2, orange 2.

The two sides of the ice cream match: parts that mirror each other have the same colour.

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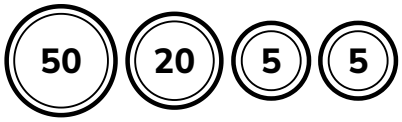
P1-15

Coin Purses

★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)

Add the coins in each purse.
Write the total in cents.
Use the code table.

1. 

_____ ¢

2. 

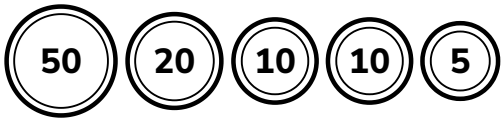
_____ ¢

3. 

_____ ¢

4. 

_____ ¢

5. 

_____ ¢

Code table

20 = H	25 = N	35 = Q	40 = A	45 = F	60 = I
65 = D	80 = P	90 = C	95 = O		

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it a music maker? ☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-16

Shop Prices

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: dollars, more and less

Read the clues.
Cross a box if a clue says no.
Tick a box if it must be yes.
Write each price, then its letter.

The prices are:

$5 S	$7 E	$8 K	$12 B	$15 A

- The kite costs $3 more than the ball.
- The book costs more than the pen.
- The pen costs more than the cup.
- The pen costs more than the ball.

	$5	$7	$8	$12	$15
pen					
book					
ball					
kite					
cup					

	price	letter
pen		
book		
ball		
kite		
cup		

The ball and the pen cost $[ ] together. Code letter [ ]

Code table

$7 = B	$17 = T	$19 = W	$27 = F

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word? You carry shopping in it.

[ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

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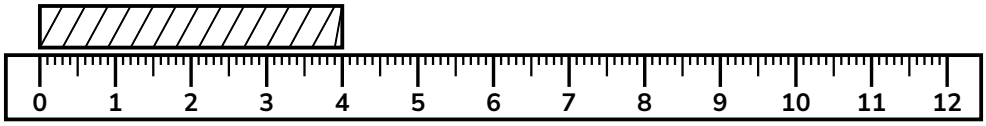
P1-17

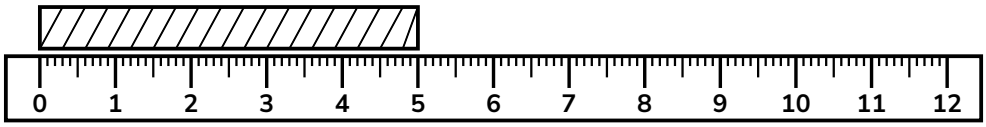
How Long?

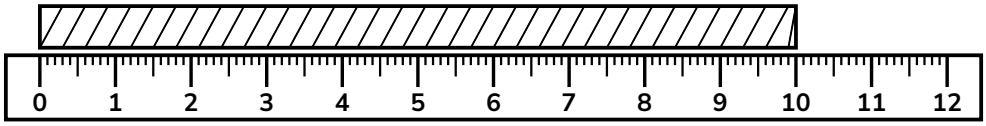
★ Name _____

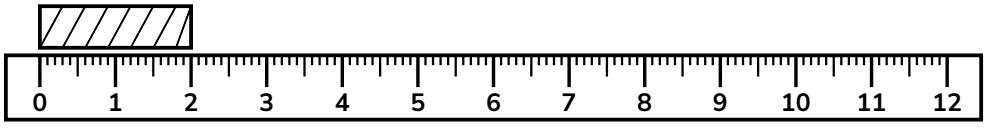
Topic: Length: measure in centimetres

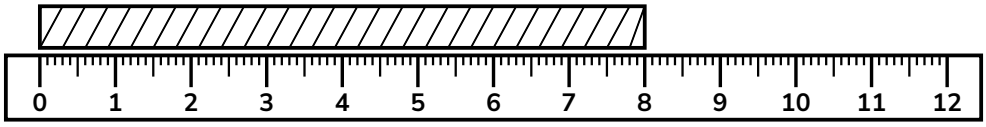
Each strip starts at 0 on its ruler.
Write how long it is in cm.
Use the code table.

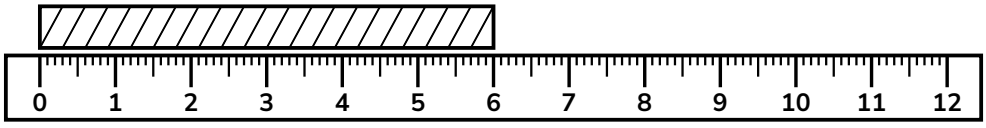
1  ☐ cm

2  ☐ cm

3  ☐ cm

4  ☐ cm

5  ☐ cm

6  ☐ cm

Code table

1 = B	2 = C	4 = P	5 = E	6 = L	7 = Z
8 = I	10 = N	11 = J	12 = F		

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Is it used for writing? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-18

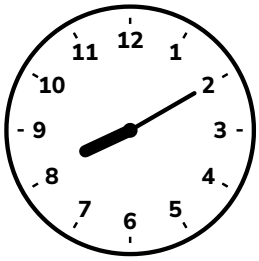
Clock Time

★★ Name _____

Topic: Time: tell time to 5 minutes; 1 hour and half an hour later

Read each clock.
Find the time later.
Write it in the boxes.
Use the code table.

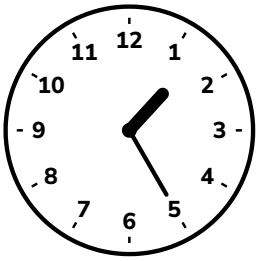
1



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

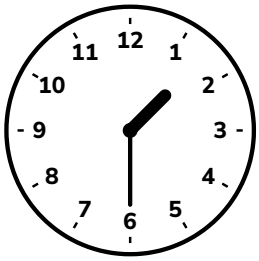
2



What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

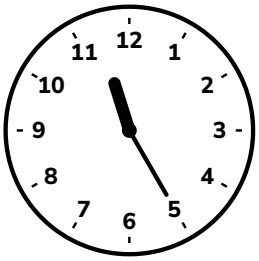
3



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

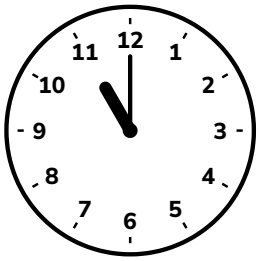
4



What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

5



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

Code table

2:35 = Z	5:05 = X	9:10 = T	11:55 = E	12:55 = K
6:05 = C	2:30 = M	1:55 = I	1:00 = Q	12:00 = R
2:55 = B				

Check it. Write the letters in order. They spell a word. Does it count the time? ☐☐☐☐☐

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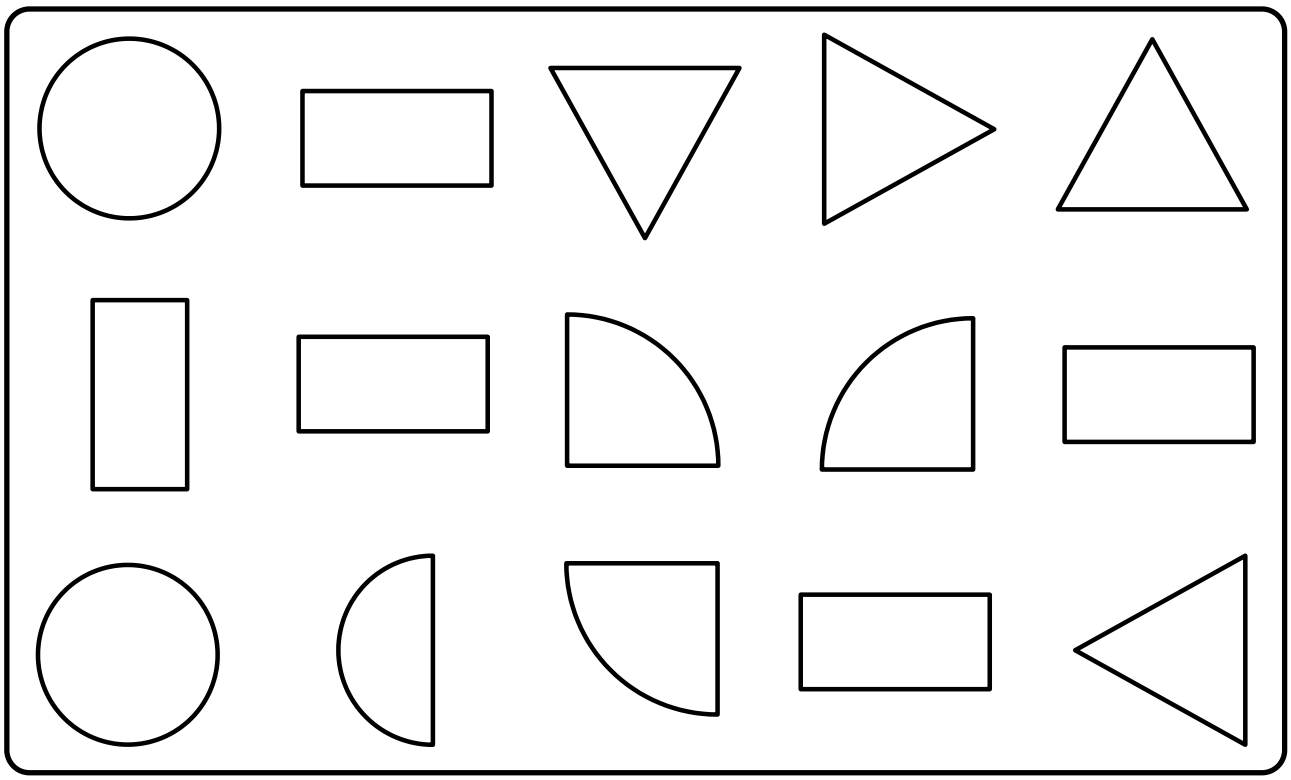
P1-19

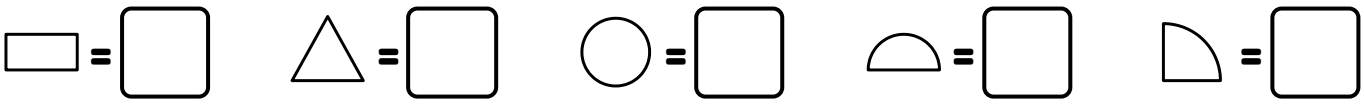
Shape Count

Name _____

Topic: 2D shapes: rectangle, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle

Count each kind of shape in the picture.
Write how many in the box.
Use the code table.





Code table

1 = P	2 = A	3 = E	4 = H	5 = S	6 = F
7 = X	8 = C				

Check it. Do your five numbers add to 15? Write the letters. Do they spell a word?

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P1-20

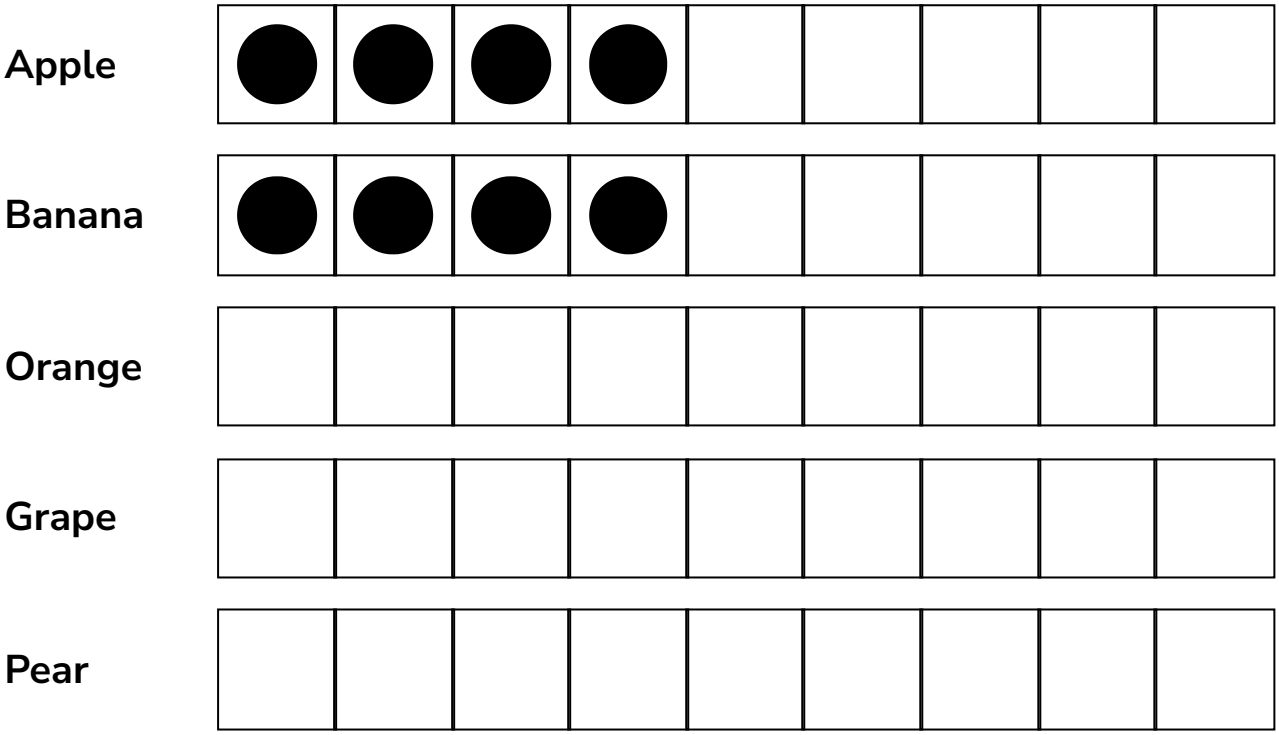
Fruit Graph

★★ Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read, complete and answer

Two rows are done.
Use the clues to draw the other rows.
Draw one circle for each child.
Then answer a and b.

Children chose a fruit. ● = 1 child.



- Orange has 4 more than Apple.
- Grape has 1 more than Banana.
- Pear has 1 fewer than Banana.

a) Most children chose ☐.

b) **Orange** has ☐ more than **Pear**.

Check it. Count all the circles. Is the total 24?

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